Describing people and places

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Describe what people look like (aspecto físico)
- Describe personality (carácter) with adjectives
- Describe places with there is / there are and prepositions
- Put adjectives in the right order before the noun

Para pensar

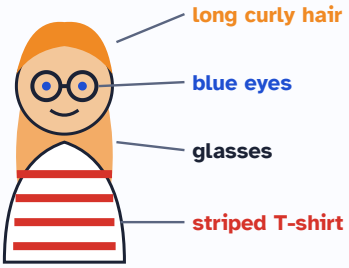
«What does she look like?» y «What is she like?» parecen casi iguales. ¿Preguntan lo mismo?

Explicación

Appearance: body and face

To describe **appearance** (aspecto) we use *be* and *have got*. With be: «He **is** tall / short / medium height», «She **is** young / old», «They **are** slim / strong».

With have got: «She **has got** blue eyes», «He **has got** a beard / a moustache / freckles (pecas)». We also say «He **wears** glasses». **En castellano:** en inglés no se dice «es de ojos azules», sino «tiene ojos azules»: *has got blue eyes*. Y los adjetivos no tienen plural: «blue eyes», nunca «blues eyes».



Hair

For **hair** we usually say length, then style, then colour: long / short / medium-length, straight / wavy / curly, blond / brown / black / red / grey. «She's got **long curly brown** hair», «He's got **short straight black** hair». We can also say «He's **bald**» (calvo) or «She has got a **ponytail**» (coleta).

En castellano: *hair* es incontable cuando hablamos del pelo de la cabeza: «Her hair **is** long», no «her hairs are».



Personality

To describe **personality** (carácter) we ask What is he like? . Positive adjectives: **kind** (amable), **friendly** (simpático), **funny** (gracioso), **clever** (listo), **brave** (valiente), **hard-working** (trabajador), **generous**, **patient**, **calm**.

Negative ones: **lazy** (vago), **bossy** (mandón), **shy** (tímido, not really negative!), **rude** (maleducado), **moody**. Give an example to show it: «My grandpa is very **patient**: he always helps me with my homework». **Consejo:** usa *very*, *quite* y *a bit* para matizar.

Positive	Negative
kind	rude
hard-working	lazy
brave	bossy
calm	moody

Adjective order

In English, adjectives go **before** the noun: «a **big** house», never «a house big». When there are several, they follow an order: opinion – size – age – shape – colour – material + noun.

«a **beautiful old** castle», «a **small round wooden** table», «a **nice big red** bike». **En castellano:** en español el adjetivo suele ir detrás («una casa grande»), por eso en inglés hay que pensar al revés. No uses más de dos o tres adjetivos seguidos.

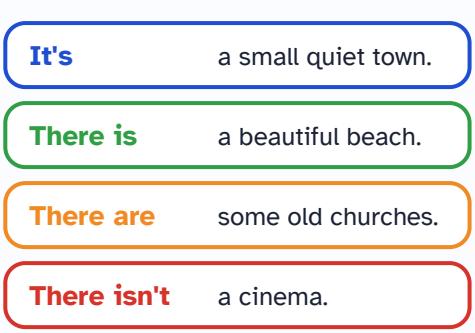


opinion · size · age · colour + noun

Describing places

To describe a place we use there is / there are and adjectives: «My town is **small** and **quiet**. There **is** a **beautiful** beach and there **are** some **old** churches. There **isn't** a cinema».

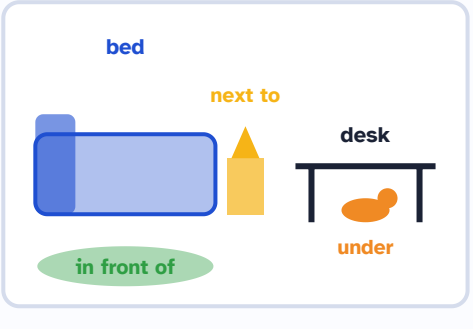
Useful adjectives for places: **big, small, busy** (con mucha gente), **quiet** (tranquilo), **noisy** (ruidoso), **modern, old, clean, dirty, crowded, peaceful**. **En castellano:** empieza por lo general (cómo es) y luego explica qué hay.



Where is it? Prepositions of place

Prepositions of place say where things are: **in** (dentro), **on** (encima), **under** (debajo), **next to** (al lado de), **between** (entre), **behind** (detrás), **in front of** (delante de), **opposite** (enfrente de), **near** (cerca).

«The lamp is **next to** the bed», «The cat is **under** the desk», «The bank is **opposite** the park», «The school is **between** the library and the pool». **En castellano:** ojo con *in front of* (delante) y *opposite* (enfrente, al otro lado).



Reading: my best friend and my street

Read Adam's description: «My best friend is Sofía. She's quite tall and she has got **short wavy black** hair and **big brown** eyes. She wears glasses. She's very **funny**

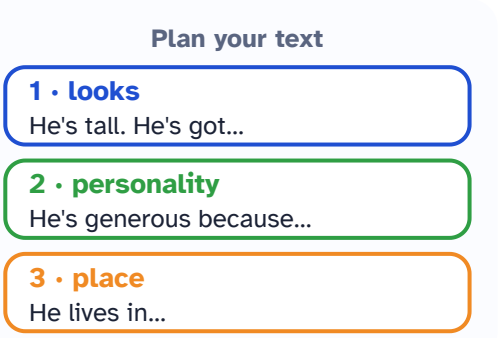
and **kind**, but a bit **shy** with new people. She lives in my street. It's a **quiet** street with **tall** trees. There's a bakery **next to** her house and there's a small park **opposite** my flat. We play there every afternoon».



Writing a description

Plan your description in **three paragraphs** (párrafos): 1) **Who** and **appearance** («My uncle Javi is tall...»), 2) **personality** with examples («He's very generous: he always...»), 3) **place** or **activities** («He lives in a flat near the sea...»).

Use connectors: **and**, **but**, **also**, **because**. «She's shy **but** very friendly», «I like him **because** he's funny». **Consejo:** relee tu texto para comprobar el orden de los adjetivos y que hayas usado *has got* con los ojos y el pelo.

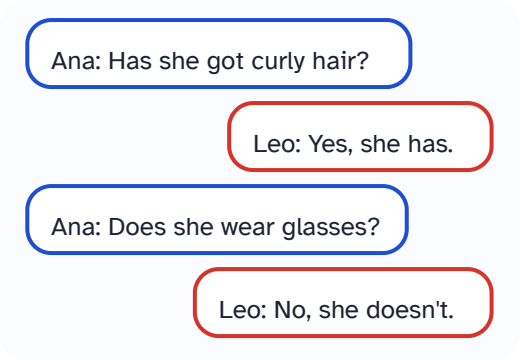


Let's practise: Guess who?

Play «Guess who?» with pictures of people or classmates (with respect!). Ask only yes/no questions: «Has he got curly hair?» – «No, he hasn't». «Is she wearing a red jumper?» – «Yes, she is». «Does he wear glasses?» – «Yes, he does».

Then describe a place in the classroom without saying its name: «It's next to the window and opposite the door. There are lots of books on it». Your partner

guesses: «The bookshelf!». **Consejo:** describe con respeto, sin palabras que puedan molestar a nadie.



Describing people and places



Ejercicios

1. **Translate: «Tiene el pelo corto y rizado.»**

2. **Order: «car / red / a / small».**

3. **Write the opposite: tall, quiet, lazy, old.**

4. **Which question asks about personality?**

5. **Complete: «The bank is ___ the park.» (enfrente de)**

6. **Complete: «My bag is ___ my chair.» (debajo de)**

7. **Correct: «My sister has got browns eyes.»**

8. **Complete: «There ___ two parks in my town.»**

9. **Describe your bedroom in two sentences.**

10. **Describe a family member in three sentences.**

Practica

1. **«What does she look like?» asks about...**

   A) personality
   B) appearance
   C) hobbies

2. **«What is he like?» asks about...**

   A) appearance
   B) his job
   C) personality

3. **«She ___ got green eyes.»**

   A) has
   B) is
   C) have

4. **Correct order:**

   A) an old beautiful house
   B) a house beautiful old
   C) a beautiful old house

5. **«Curly» describes...**

   A) eyes
   B) hair
   C) personality

6. **Someone who never wants to work is...**

   A) lazy
   B) brave
   C) kind

7. **«The ball is ___ the box.» (dentro)**

   A) on
   B) in
   C) under

8. **«delante de» is...**

   A) behind

B) opposite

C) in front of

9. **«Her hair ___ long.»**

A) is

B) are

C) have

10. **A place with lots of noise is...**

A) quiet

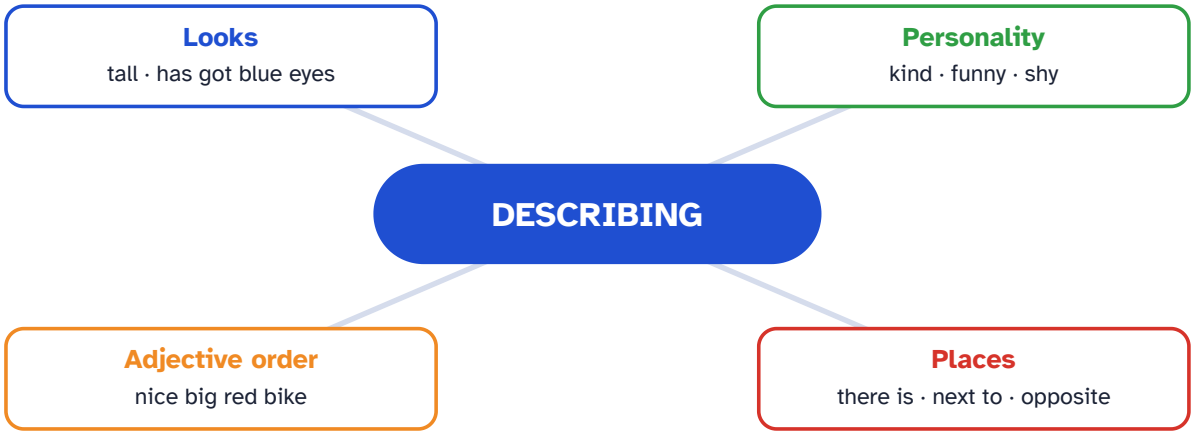
B) noisy

C) peaceful

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Diferencia entre What is he like? y What does he look like?; Cómo describir el pelo y los ojos; En qué orden van los adjetivos; Cómo describir un lugar con there is / there are y preposiciones.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

What does she look like?

¿Cómo es físicamente?

What is she like?

¿Cómo es de carácter?

has got blue eyes

Tiene los ojos azules.

long curly hair

Pelo largo y rizado.

kind / funny / shy

Amable / gracioso / tímido.

Adjective order

Opinión, tamaño, edad, color + nombre.

in front of / behind

Delante de / detrás de.

opposite

Enfrente de.

Soluciones

1. **B)** Aspecto físico.
2. **C)** Forma de ser.
3. **A)** She + has got.
4. **C)** Opinión antes que edad.
5. **B)** Pelo rizado.
6. **A)** Lazy = vago.
7. **B)** In = dentro.
8. **C)** In front of.
9. **A)** Hair es incontable.
10. **B)** Noisy = ruidoso.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. She has got short curly hair (o He has got...).
2. a small red car.
3. short, noisy, hard-working, young (o new).
4. What is he like?
5. opposite.
6. under.
7. My sister has got brown eyes.
8. are.
9. Model answer: There is a bed next to the window. My desk is opposite the door.
10. Model answer: My mum is tall. She has got short brown hair. She's very kind and funny.